

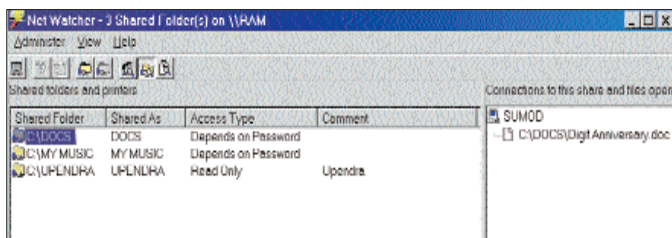
30 Minutes Expert

Watch your shares

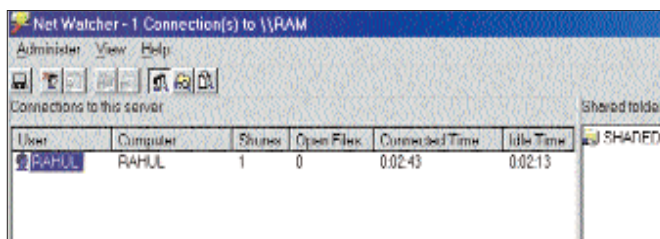
Sharing folders over a LAN and accessing other's shared folders is quite easy. If you do not maintain discipline with your sharing habits, you may end up sharing dozens of folders from all over your system. Keeping tabs on what folders are shared and who is accessing them is rather difficult, if all you have is Windows Explorer.

Windows 98, 2000 and XP all have utilities to help you manage your shared resources and track their usage. As far as the Windows file-sharing system is con-

Add/Remove Programs > Windows Setup > System Tools.



Which shared folder has the highest traffic?



Keep tabs on people picking up your files

some of the shared folders, or share more folders. For each folder, NetWatcher will show you a list of people connected to it, and the files they are working with.

The third view shows the complete list of open files on your system across shares and users. An interesting option for people on a LAN with Windows NT or 2000 servers is NetWatcher's ability to connect to the server and display the activity on the server.

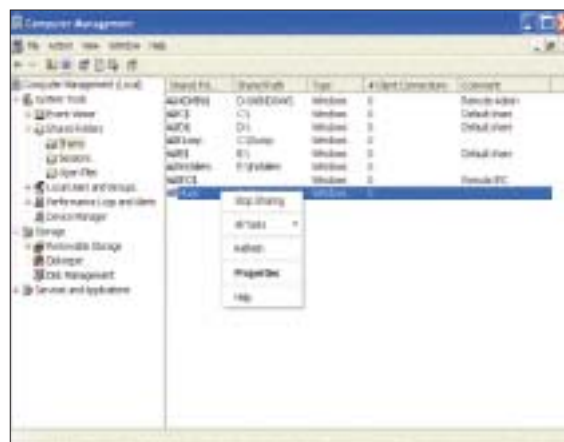
If you run Windows 2000, or XP on your computer, there is no NetWatcher application to be found. Instead, similar functionality can be accessed via **Control Panel > Administrative Tools**

> Computer Management > Shared Folders.

The Shared Folders snap-in has no

When you run NetWatcher, you will be presented with a list people that are currently connected to your computer, and the resources they are using. You can select any of the people listed here and disconnect them. A forced disconnect will terminate all file transfers, or printing tasks immediately. However a disconnection does not impose a ban on that user. He can reconnect and start transferring files or printing again.

The second view in NetWatcher will show you the list of shared folders on your computer. From this view, you can choose to un-share



Windows 2000 and XP offer unified computer management including shares

toolbar to perform actions, but everything that you do in NetWatcher can be done via the context menu. Right-click on any object to get a list of actions possible with that object, including disconnecting users, adding and removing file shares etc.

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Install NetWatcher from your Windows 98 CD ROM

cerned, there are three objects to be managed—the list of shared resources, people connected to these resources and the specific files opened, or printers used. On Windows 98, NetWatcher lets you keep track of, and manage, all three.

NetWatcher is not installed with the default configuration of Windows 98. If it is not in your **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools** menu, then you must install it from **Control Panel >**



The global perspective on every file accessed on your computer